Gabriel Lévesque

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Updated: October 31, 2026.

APPOINTMENTS

Voss Postdoctoral Research Associate, Brown University 2026–
Institute at Brown for Environment & Society (IBES)
Faculty supervisor: Scott Frickel

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Sociology, McGill University 2026
Dissertation: "Structures of Latency: The Protraction of Regulatory Controversies over Toxic Substances"
Committee: Barry Eidlin (chair), Axel van Den Berg (co-chair), Peter McMahan, Antonia Maioni

M.A. Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal 2021
B.A. Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal 2018

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

(14) **Lévesque, Gabriel V.** 2027. "The Relational Structure of Corporate Ignorance Production," *Social Networks*, 88: 32–43.

(13) **Lévesque, Gabriel V**. 2026. "The Appalachian Regional Commission and the Articulation of the Coal Consensus," *Social Science History*, 50(3): 480–504.

(12) **Lévesque, Gabriel V.** 2026. "Contesting state expertise after COVID-19," *Public Understanding of Science*, 35(1): 44–62.

(11) **Lévesque, Gabriel V.** 2025. "Why is Coal Still Mined? Insights from Asbestos and the Structures of Risk Invisibilization," *Theory and Social Inquiry*, 1(1): 1–46.

- Honorable Mention, Graduate Student Paper Award, Political Sociology Section, American Sociological Association, 2026.
- Honorable Mention, Graduate Student Paper Award, Environmental Sociology Section, American Sociological Association, 2026.

(10) Benoit, Maude & **Gabriel V. Lévesque.** 2025. "Implementing ambiguity: Blame avoidance and moral policy in Canadian cannabis legalization," *International Review of Public Policy*, 7(1): 1–23.

(9) **Lévesque, Gabriel V**. & Maude Benoit. 2025. "Coping Strategies and Policy Alienation Under Centralization and Performance Management: Evidence From a Survey of Quebec Homecare Workers" *Administration & Society*, 57(3): 368–398.

(8) Benoit, Maude, **Gabriel V. Lévesque** & Paul Treille. 2024. "Intervenir sans s'investir : le désengagement discret, mais structurant de l'État dans les politiques agroenvironnementale et de légalisation du cannabis au Canada," *Revue Internationale de Politique Comparée,* 31(1): 5–48.

(7) **Lévesque, Gabriel**. 2023. "Making sense of pot. Conceptual tools for a critical analysis of cannabis policy discourse," *Critical Policy Studies*, 17(1): 4–23.

(6) Benoit, Maude & **Gabriel Lévesque**. 2022. "La légalisation du cannabis au Canada : les stratégies de résistance du Québec à une politique unilatérale du fédéral," *Gouvernance*, 19(2): 77–98.

(5) **Lévesque, Gabriel**. 2022. "Cadrage des modèles de régulation du cannabis : entre concurrence et complémentarité," *Drogues, Santé et Société*, 20(2): 23-47.

(4) Benoit, Maude, **Gabriel Lévesque** & Léonie Perron. 2022. "De la vocation à prendre soin au joug de la performance : dévoiler les réalités des travailleuses du *care* pour comprendre la crise du système de santé et de services sociaux," *Lien social et Politiques*, 88: 66-88.

(3) **Lévesque, Gabriel**. 2022. "From Right or Wrong to True or False: Moral and Epistemic Framing in Debates Over Cannabis Policy Reformulation," *Politics & Policy*, 50(4): 773-794.

(2) **Lévesque, Gabriel**. 2021. "Stratégies de redéfinition de l'enjeu de l'amiante au Québec (1949-2013)," *Politique et sociétés*, 40(3): 151-176.

(1) **Lévesque, Gabriel** & Maude Benoit. 2020. "Legalize or Prohibit It? Quebec's Exceptionalism on Cannabis and the Framing of Evidence in Policymaking," *American Review of Canadian Studies*, 50(3): 371-385.

UNDER REVIEW

Lévesque, Gabriel V. "Corporate political power, regulatory change and network interdependence: A long-term view from the lead controversy in the United States, 1924-2003," Revise and Resubmit at *Social Forces*.

- Best Graduate Student Paper Award, Political Sociology, Canadian Sociological Association, 2023.

McMahan, Peter & **Gabriel V. Lévesque**. "Expert agencies have outsized influence on the contents of science," Under review at *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*.

Lévesque, Gabriel V. & Ann-Marie Helou. "The rise and fall of the Coalition Avenir Québec: insights from political donations data" (Research note), *Canadian Journal of Political Science / Revue Canadienne de Science Politique*.

IN PROGRESS

Lévesque, Gabriel V. "Crushing victories: Environmental health activism and the hazardous politics of expertise," Book manuscript.

Lévesque, Gabriel V. "Lay theories of power."

Lévesque, Gabriel V. & Fabio Robibaro. "It's written in the stars: astrology, partner compatibility and blame attribution in online dating advice."

BOOK CHAPTERS

Lévesque, Gabriel V. 2024. "Controverses sur l'or noir : l'évolution du cadrage médiatique des projets pétroliers canadiens dans le Midwest américain (2010-2020)", dans Gagnon, Frédérick & Christophe Cloutier-Roy (ed.), *L'Amérique d'abord, le Canada ensuite. Les relations canado-américaines de Donald Trump à Joe Biden* (Ch. 6), Montréal: Presses de l'Université de Montréal.

Benoit, Maude & **Gabriel Lévesque**. 2020. "Que nous apprend la légalisation du cannabis sur le fédéralisme canadien?", dans Mathieu, Félix, Dave Guénette & Alain-G. Gagnon (ed.), *Cinquante déclinaisons de fédéralisme: théories, enjeux et études de cas* (Ch. 44: 587-598), Québec: Presses de l'Université du Québec.

BOOK REVIEWS

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2023. "Qualitative Literacy: A Guide to Evaluating Ethnographic and Interview Research, Mario Luis Small et Jessica McCrory Calarco, 2022, Oakland, CA: University of California Press, 230 p." *Politique et sociétés*, 42(3), p. 220-222.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2021. "Colin Jerolmack. Up to Heaven and Down to Hell: Fracking, Freedom, and community in an American Town Princeton: Princeton University Press, 2021, £25.00 pbk, (ISBN: 9780691179032) 336 pp.", *Sociology*, 56(2): 406-407.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2020. "The Rise and Fall of Moral Conflicts in the United States and Canada by Mildred A. Schwartz and Raymond Talatovich. Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 2018. 240 pages, £20.99. ISBN: 978-1-44262-883-0", *Political Studies Review*, NP11-NP12.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2020. "Experts, sciences et sociétés, sous la dir. de François Claveau et Julien Prud'homme, Montreal, Les Presses de l'Université de Montreal, 2018, 284 p.", *Politique et sociétés*, 39(1): 191-194.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2019. "La Coalition Avenir Québec. Une idéologie à la recherche du pouvoir, de Frédéric Boily, Sainte-Foy: Presses de l'Université Laval, 2018", *Canadian Journal of Political Science/Revue Canadienne de science politique*, 52(4): 950-952.

REPORTS

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2023. "Cannabis regulation in Canada: Case Studies. Cannabis Policy Implementation in Ontario (2018-2022)," *Observatoire français des drogues et des tendances addictives*. [en.] [fr.], 50 p.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2022. "Données pour : Analyse de cadrage de la reformulation des politiques en matière de cannabis au Québec, en Ontario et au Maine," , *Borealis*, V1.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2022. Cadrages de la reformulation des politiques en matière de cannabis, *M.A Thesis,* Department of Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal, 167 p.

Benoit, Maude, Léonie Perron & **Gabriel Lévesque**. 2021. "Que se passe-t-il aux premières lignes du soutien à domicile au Québec ? Rapport d'enquête", *État 21*, 24 p.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2020. "La légalisation du cannabis au Canada: Les défis de la mise en œuvre en Colombie-Britannique, en Ontario et au Québec", *French Monitoring Centre for Drugs and Drug Addiction*, 110 p.

Gagnon, Frédérick & al. 2020. "L'effet COVID-19 sur les relations entre le Canada, le Québec et les États-Unis", *Center for United States Studies*, *Chaire Raoul*-Dandurand, 33 p.

SCIENTIFIC OUTREACH

Cited in North, Harry, "Asbestos in Canada: A forgotten killer remains at large," McGill Tribune, August 2023.

Cited in Swanson, Ross, "Tomlinson Doctoral Scholarships: Supporting PhD student achievement," McGill Reporter, August 9th 2023.

Guest on Treille, Paul and Gaël Yvon, "Décriminalisation et criminalisation du cannabis," *Le Brunch Politique*, Episode 1.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2020. "Quelle est la différence entre la légalisation d'une drogue et sa décriminalisation ?," *État 21*.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2020. "Cartographie de la légalisation du cannabis en Amérique du Nord," *État 21*.

Lévesque, Gabriel. 2020. "Une brève histoire du cannabis au Canada," *État 21*.

Benoit, Maude & **Gabriel Lévesque**. "Cannabis: entre normalisation et quasi-prohibition", *La Presse*, October 21st 2019.

Lévesque, Gabriel. "La croisade symbolique de la CAQ contre le cannabis", *Le Devoir*, October 19th 2019.

Benoit, Maude & **Gabriel Lévesque**. 2019. "What Can Cannabis Legalisation Teach Us About Canadian Federalism," *50 Shades of Federalism*.

Maret, Fenohasina Rakotondrazaka & **Gabriel Lévesque**. 2019. "Greater transparency is still possible for single-party democracies in Africa," *Urban Wire*.

Benoit, Maude & Gabriel **Lévesque**. 2018. "Que la légalisation du cannabis nous apprend-elle sur le fédéralisme canadien ?," *50 déclinaisons de fédéralisme*.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2024–2025	Thematic expert, Observatoire national de l'amiante
2023–2024	Research Assistant, Department of Equity, Ethics and Policy, McGill University Autism and the Welfare State
2020–2023	Research Associate, French Monitoring Centre for Drugs and Drug Addiction
2018–2023	Research Assistant, Groupe de recherche sur l'État et l'action publique au 21e siècle
2018–2021	Resident Fellow, Center for United States Studies, Chaire Raoul-Dandurand
2018	Research Assistant, Urban Institute

TEACHING

Graduate instructor of record

W2025	POL 8007 – Graduate Research Methods in Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal (with Maude Benoit)

Undergraduate instructor of record

W2025	POL 1850 – Quantitative Methods, Université du Québec à Montréal
W2025	SOCI 225 – Medicine and Health in Modern Society, McGill University
F2024	SOC 307 – Sociology of Health, Bishop's University
F2024	POL 1502 – Introduction to Public Administration and Public Policy, Université du Québec à Montréal (with Maude Benoit)
S2024	SOCI 211 – Sociological Inquiry, McGill University
F2023	POL 1502 – Introduction to Public Administration and Public Policy, Université du Québec à Montréal (replacement for leave)

Teaching assistant

F2023	SOCI 326 – Political Sociology, McGill University (Matthew Lange)
F2022	SOCI 325 – Sociology of Science, McGill University (Peter McMahan)
F2021	SOCI 312 – Sociology of Work and Industry, McGill University (Barry Eidlin)
F2020	POL 4142 – United States Political System, Université du Québec à Montréal (Frédérick Gagnon)
F2020 W2019	POL 1502 – Introduction to Public Administration and Public Policy, Université du Québec à Montréal (Maude Benoit)

Other

Graduate introduction to quantitative analysis, Department of Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal, 2023, 2024
Academic Counsellor, Paulo Freire Center in Political Science, 2019-2020
Teaching Intern, Collège Ahuntsic, W2018

INVITED TALKS

Crushing victories: Environmental health activism and the hazardous politics of expertise

Amherst College (Amherst MA, US), November 5, 2026
Civic and Political Organizations Workshop, Harvard University (Cambridge MA, US), September 21, 2026

Why is Coal Still Mined?, Brown University (Providence RI, US), October 14, 2026.

The Appalachian Regional Commission and the Articulation of the U.S. Coal Consensus, Sociologies of Energy Transitions Workshop, Harvard University (Cambridge MA, US), March 27, 2026.

Five years of Legal Cannabis in Canada: What a long, strange trip it's been, Canadian Sociological Association Annual Conference (Online), June 20, 2024.

Pouvoir règlementaire et hétérogénéité des cadres de référence dans la mobilisation pour la santé environnementale à Rouyn-Noranda, Observatoire national sur les incidences des émissions de contaminants sur la santé et l'environnement (Rouyn-Noranda, Canada), May 26, 2024.

Why is Coal Still Mined?, Weatherhead Center for International Studies, Harvard University (Cambridge MA, US), February 20, 2024.

Les politiques de régulation du cannabis en Ontario et au Québec, Faculty of Medicine and Health Sciences, Sherbrooke University (Longueuil, Canada), June 22, 2023.

Conflits de valeurs vécus aux premières lignes du soutien à domicile : les impacts sur les services offerts aux usagers (with Maude Benoit and Léonie Perron), Symposium du Regroupement des commissaires aux plaintes et à la qualité des services du Québec (Online), January 21, 2022

RECENT CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (2022–)

2026

The Relational Structure of Corporate Ignorance Production
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (New York, U.S.), August 9th.
Sociological Science Conference (Palo Alto, U.S.), June 4th.

Crushing victories: Environmental health activism and the hazardous politics of expertise
SKAT pre-conference, American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (New York, U.S.), August 7th.

Cognitive heterogeneity and lay theories of regulatory power
Eastern Sociological Society (Washington DC, U.S.), March 5th.

Regulatory processes and the politics of environmental expertise
Eastern Sociological Society (Washington DC, U.S.), March 5th.

2025

The Relational Structure of Ignorance Production
Canadian Sociological Association Annual Conference (Toronto, Canada), June 1st.
Congrès de la Société québécoise de science politique (Montreal, Canada), May 21st.
McGill Sociology Department Research Series (Montreal, Canada), February 3rd.

Do States Make Scientific Fields? (with Peter McMahan)
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (Chicago, U.S.), August 9th.
Canadian Sociological Association Annual Conference (Toronto, Canada), June 3rd.
Sociological Science Conference (Ithaca, U.S.), June 2nd.

Network Interdependence and the Regulation of Toxic Substances
Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (Montreal, Canada), July 11th.

2024

The Appalachian Regional Commission and the Consolidation of the U.S. Coal Consensus
Social Science History Association Annual Conference (Toronto, Canada), November 1st.

Toxic Substance Regulations and the Structuration of Interdependent Policy Networks.
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (Montreal, Canada), August 12th.
Canadian Sociological Association Annual Conference (Montreal, Canada), June 21st.

Why is Coal Still Mined?
Social Science History Association Annual Conference (Washington DC, U.S.), November 16th.
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, U.S.), August 18th.
Canadian Sociological Association Annual Conference (Toronto, Canada), May 30th.

2023 *The Evolving Media Framing of Enbridge Pipelines in the Midwest*
Association for Canadian Studies in the United States Conference (Washington DC, US), November 19th.

Savoirs experts et savoirs profanes : esquisse d'une approche par les ressources épistémiques
Entretiens Jacques-Cartier, Invisibilité de la santé au travail dans le secteur public (Grenoble, France), October 9th.

Presider of *La compensation en pratique : les organisations de victimes et leurs alliances*
Entretiens Jacques-Cartier, Invisibilité de la santé au travail dans le secteur public (Grenoble, France), October 9th.

2022 *Intervenir sans s'investir : le désengagement de l'État dans les politiques agroenvironnementales et de légalisation du cannabis au Canada et au Québec* (with Paul Treille).
Colloque Politiques et management public (Paris, France), June 30th.

Making sense of pot. Conceptual tools for a critical analysis of cannabis policy discourse
Interpretive Policy Analysis Conference (Barcelona, Catalonia [Online]), June 29th.

SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2026–2028	Voss Postdoctoral Fellowship Institute at Brown for Environment & Society (USD 136,000)
2026–2028	Postdoctoral Scholarship Fonds de recherche du Québec (CAD 110,000) *Rank: 2nd/11*
2026	Bourse Shirley-Goldenberg Centre de recherche interuniversitaire sur la mondialisation et le travail (CAD 2,500)
2026	Bourse d'étude, Observatoire national de l'amiante (CAD 25,000)
2025	Charles R. Bronfman and Alex K. Paterson Top-Up Award Institute for the Study of Canada, McGill University (CAD 5,500)
2022–2025	Joseph-Armand-Bombardier / Canada Graduate Scholarship – PhD Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (CAD 105,000) *Rank: 14th/151*
2021–2024	Richard H. Tomlinson Doctoral Fellowship, McGill University (CAD 105,000; partially declined)
2021–2025	Doctoral Scholarship Fonds de recherche du Québec (CAD 84,000; partially declined) *Rank: 1st/19*
2020–2021	Canada Graduate Scholarships – M.A. Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (CAD 17,500)
2020	Excellence Scholarship, University of Quebec Foundation (CAD 2,000)
2020	Institutional Scholarship, University of Quebec in Montreal (CAD 4,000)
2020	M.A. Fellowship, Montreal Institute of International Studies (CAD 2,500)
2019	Scholarship, Political Science, University of Quebec in Montreal (CAD 1,000)
2018	Scholarship Award, The Washington Center (USD 4,000)

MOBILITY ACTIVITIES AND FUNDING

2025 Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University, United States
McGill Department of Sociology Scholarship (CAD 2,500)
2025 Archival research at the University of Utah, the University of Colorado-Boulder and the American Heritage Center, United States
Graduate Mobility Award, McGill University (CAD 1,700)
2024 Social Science History Association meeting, Toronto, Canada
Richard Sutch Graduate Travel Grant (USD 500)
Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel Award, McGill University (CAD 350)
2024 Archival research at the U.S. National Archives, College Park, United States
Schull Yang International Experience Award, McGill University (CAD 3,500)
Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel Award, McGill University (CAD 800)
2023 Archival research at the University of Kentucky and Berea College, United States
Graduate Mobility Award, McGill University (CAD 1,500)
2022 Colloque Politiques et management public, Paris, France
Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel Award, McGill University (CAD 1,250)
2019 Annual Congress of the French Political Science Association, Bordeaux, France
French Political Science Association (€ 250)
Political Science Department, Université du Québec à Montréal (CAD 1,700)
2019 International Summer Research Institute, EURAC Research Center, Bolzano, Italy
Interdisciplinary Research Center on Diversity and Democracy (CAD 1,400)
2019 Washington Center, Academic Internship & Seminar Program, United States
Université du Québec à Montréal, Mobility Grant (CAD 3,500)

DISTINCTIONS

Honorable Mention, Graduate Student Paper Award, Political Sociology Section, American Sociological Association, 2026.

Honorable Mention, Graduate Student Paper Award, Environmental Sociology Section, American Sociological Association, 2026.

Best student paper award in Political Sociology, Canadian Sociological Association, 2023

Excellence mention, M.A Thesis, Department of Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal, 2021

Board of Honors, Faculty of Political Science and Law, Université du Québec à Montréal, 2019, 2017

SERVICE

2026–2027 Representative, IBES Early Career Committee
2025–2027 Student Representative, Political Sociology Section, American Sociological Association
2025–2026 Member, Student and early career scholar advisory board, Canadian Review of Sociology
2025 Scientific Committee, "Entre résidu et oubli : la fabrique des héritages toxiques. Réflexions croisées à partir du cas exemplaire de l'amiante. XXe–XXIe siècles", Sciences Po Grenoble
2024 Student coordinator, Comparative-Historical Section, American Sociological Association
2023 Co-organizer, "Invisibilité de la santé au travail dans le secteur public" Entretiens Jacques-Cartier, Sciences Po Grenoble (with Renaud Bécot)
2023 French Counsellor, Department of Sociology, McGill University
2022–2023 Vice-president, McGill Graduate Sociology Students' Association
2022–2023 Secretary-treasurer, Asbestos Victims Association of Quebec
2022 Student Representative, Hiring committee, Department of Sociology, McGill University
2021 Student Representative, Hiring committee, Department of Political Science, Université du Québec à Montréal

Ad hoc reviewer for

American Journal of Sociology
Public Understanding of Science
Frontiers in Political Science
Environmental Research Letters
Policy Studies Journal
Critical Policy Studies
International Journal of Drug Policy
Contemporary Drug Problems

TRAINING

2025	Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), Syracuse University
2024	Analyzing census data with R, McGill University
2024	Introduction to Python, McGill University
2022	Introduction to automated textual analysis, McGill University
2021	R Summer Camp, McGill University
2019	International Summer Research Institute, EURAC Research Center
2018	Internship & Seminar Program, The Washington Center

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

2025–	Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics
2023–	Social Science History Association
2023–	Canadian Sociological Association
2023–	American Sociological Association
2023–	Association for Canadian Studies in the United States
2019–	Société Québécoise de science politique